

A LOCAL'S GUIDE TO FAMILY FUN IN CARLISLE AND CUMBRIA



Skip the tourist trail. Here's what families who actually live here do — and love.

If you ask a Cumbrian parent about their weekend plans, you will get the same answer: "There's so much to do here." Although if you ask them to check off five specific activities, they might think for a moment longer than expected. It's not because there's nothing, but because there are so many great ones to choose from.

Carlisle and Cumbria offer impressive family experiences. But here's the big challenge: knowing which ones are actually worth your time and assuredly discussing with children who wish to try something different.

Are you a Cumbrian family or visitors looking for a genuine experience? Here's your guide to [fun family activities in Cumbria](#) that actually work for you.

Start Here - Why Carlisle Is The City Families Love

Carlisle is a family-friendly spot that is above its size. The city center is compact and full of history and easily explored on foot, for free or very affordably.

Carlisle Castle has a real medieval fortress with almost 900 years of history behind it, from the Norman conquest to Bonnie Prince Charlie. It's well-managed by English Heritage, and there's free entry for children.

You will find Tullie House Museum and Art Gallery a short walk from the Castle. The Roman frontier galleries are hands-on and well-designed for children, and the natural history section holds genuine fascination for younger ones. Again, free to enter for children, a rarity these days.

And then there's BrickStation on Nelson Street, one of the city's most loved family spots and, frankly, one that not enough people outside Carlisle know about. More on that shortly.

Head Outside - Cumbria's Best Family Outdoor Spots

Most visitors think they need to climb Scafell Pike to enjoy with their families, but it's not true. Now, you can explore Cumbria, which is the most amazing, perfect landscape for family outings; you just need a good walkway, a packed lunch, and a fun destination.

If you like peace at the seaside, then you have to visit Talikn Tarn Country Park. It's located outside Brampton, a local favourite site where time really flies, and it's not too crowded. It's an easy circular walk around a beautiful lake for wild swimming and paddling, and a tearoom that's been serving families for years.

You can explore the Winlatter Forest, near Keswick, which is the only true mountain in England. Here you can spot red squirrels in their natural habitat, the [Go Ape](#) treetop adventure course for children, and marked cycling routes for everyone. There's also a warm and cozy Visitor Centre Cafe welcoming you in Cumbria.

Don't miss the chance to visit Aira Force waterfall near Ullswater, a hidden gem in Cumbria! It's a straightforward walk from the National Trust car park. After checking out the surprising 20-meter waterfall, your child will be in wonder, and you will create remarkable memories with your family. Few things silence an "are we nearly there yet" like that.

Rainy Day? Cumbria Has You Covered

Let's be honest about the Cumbrian climate. Rain is part of the deal. However, there is a great list of fun indoor activities shared by the locals.

Don't miss checking out the hillside near Penrith, the charming Rheged Discovery Centre. There are rotating exhibitions, shopping, a giant-screen cinema showing amazing nature films, and soft play for your children. It's a wonderful place to spend half a day without doubting the weather forecast.

Whether you want to love the historical places or like to know about the history of Cumbria, then explore Honister Slate Mine in the Borrowdale fells. Here, you get informative and fun underground tours, a hands-on way to learn the Cumbrian history with stories that children find thrilling.

After covering all places, if you feel tired and are looking for a relaxing, peaceful spot, don't forget to visit [BrickStation in Carlisle](#). It's like a natural home with thousands of LEGO bricks, over 250 sets to build, and 40 board games where you spend an hour, have fun, and stay for four.

BrickStation Carlisle - A Hidden Gem Waiting To Be Found

BrickStation is one of the favorite spots of local families. They often come here for a fun time with their families. It's an independent and creative [LEGO](#) learning play center located in Atlas Works on Nelson Street. This gives a calm, genuine environment for parents and soft-play, and frequently autism-friendly sessions throughout the year for their children.



There's free entry to encourage kids, a sorting zone with hot drinks, and a warm community vibe where parents can relax, which you find in family entertainment. During school holidays, it's open seven days a week from 10 am to 4 pm — making it one of the most reliable options on a Cumbrian family calendar.

THE LOCAL'S BOTTOM LINE

The best family outings in Carlisle and Cumbria often aren't the top results you search online. They're the spots that locals love to revisit, not because they're the most famous, but because they're truly enjoyable.

If you are curious, Cumbria has enough to offer! Get off the obvious route, try something your children haven't done before, and let the county surprise you. It's very good at that.



Next family day out in Carlisle sorted! BrickStation is open seven days during school holidays — a creative, inclusive, and brilliantly relaxed LEGO play and learning centre for children of all ages and abilities. Observers always go free.

Visit brickstation.co.uk to book your session and see what's on.

Don't Wait, Book Yours Now!